1962 – the gradual ratcheting up of the quarrel, the attempts to cooperate, and increasing military tensions.

Border Negotiations Resumed

For several years after the war, China–India diplomatic intercourse was low key and minimal. Intermittently, there were tensions too. In 1963, Pakistan ceded the Shaksgam area of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir to China as part of a border agreement, to which India strenuously objected. In 1965, during the India–Pakistan war, it seemed that China might open a second front against India to divert Indian forces; in the event, it chose not to do so. In June 1967, diplomats from both countries were expelled from their respective embassies for spying. From 11 to 14 September 1967, India and China fought in the eastern sector, at Nathu La in Sikkim: India's estimates put the Indian toll at eighty-eight dead and the Chinese toll at 300 dead. China's estimates are sixty-five and thirty-two, respectively.[86] On 1 October, they had another short duel at Cho La, about seven kilometres from Nathu La. For a brief time after 1968, China lent some support to the Naxalites, the Indian Maoist group. Until the mid-1970s, China also helped separatists in the Indian North-East including the Nagas and Mizos. In November 1970, Beijing accused Delhi of continuing to support both Tibetan rebels and the government of Taiwan, an accusation it continued to make periodically. When Sikkim was integrated into the Indian Union in 1974, the Chinese press ran critical commentary. Four Indian soldiers were killed in Arunachal Pradesh on 20 October 1975.[87]

The thaw

It is forgotten that this was also a period marked by calls for negotiation and by diplomatic warming. In September 1964, two years after the war, India's Ministry of External Affairs stated that Delhi would be happy to restart border negotiations if Chinese forces withdrew from seven posts in Ladakh.